

Monday, 29 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

24° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

23° 13°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

21° 13°

GLASGOW

Heavy drizzle

19° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **Senior Labour figures are reportedly united behind Andy Burnham as the party's next leader, with calls for a 'coronation' rather than a leadership contest.**

Lucy Powell and Steve Reed, both prominent Labour MPs, have publicly stated their support for Mr Burnham. This suggests a strong consensus within the party to avoid a potentially divisive election.

POLITICS · UK

- 2 **Tragic news from eastern France, where eleven people, including the pilot, have died after a plane carrying skydivers crashed.**

Local officials confirmed the incident, which saw all ten passengers and the pilot lose their lives. Investigations into the cause of the crash are now underway.

TRAGEDY · INTERNATIONAL

- 3 **In a remarkable rescue, two young boys have been pulled alive from earthquake rubble in Venezuela after being trapped for several days.**

Rescuers worked tirelessly for six hours to reach one of the boys, offering a glimmer of hope amidst the devastation. Many residents are still searching for loved ones by hand.

DISASTER · INTERNATIONAL

- 4 **With Wimbledon just around the corner, many are wondering if the dry weather will hold for the first week of the tournament.**

While temperatures are expected to remain warmer than average, forecasters predict a less intense heat and humidity than we've experienced recently. Let's hope for plenty of sunshine on the courts!

WEATHER · UK

- 5 **More people are seeking therapy for phone addiction, with some reporting screen times of up to 14 hours a day.**

Addiction treatment centres are seeing an increase in clients struggling with 'out-of-control' phone use. It highlights a growing concern about our reliance on technology.

HEALTH · UK

What's coming up

1

Actress Rakie Ayola has described her role in the upcoming 'Gavin & Stacey' finale as a 'wow moment' in her award-winning career.

Ayola, who plays a small but memorable part, shared her excitement about being involved in the much-anticipated return of the beloved show. Fans are eagerly awaiting the final instalment.

ON AIR – Are you excited for the 'Gavin & Stacey' finale? What are your predictions for the characters?

TV · COMING UP

2

Latin superstar Bad Bunny made history over the weekend, becoming the first Latin artist to headline a UK stadium show in London.

The concert was described as a massive party, filled with pride and energy. It's a huge moment for Latin music on the global stage.

ON AIR – Have you ever seen Bad Bunny live, or would you like to? What's your favourite Bad Bunny track?

MUSIC · WEEKEND

3

Missing Glastonbury? Don't worry, there's a fantastic festival on your doorstep this weekend celebrating the UK music scene!

Stars like Fatboy Slim and Becky Hill are set to play intimate local venues. It's a brilliant opportunity to catch some big names in a smaller setting.

ON AIR – Are you heading to any local festivals this weekend? Who are you most looking forward to seeing?

MUSIC · COMING UP

4

Tom Holland has been praised for his 'powerful' message on dyslexia, revealing he turned down hosting 'Saturday Night Live' due to fears about cue cards.

The actor's honesty sheds light on the challenges many face with dyslexia. His decision highlights the importance of self-care and mental well-being.

ON AIR – What do you think of Tom Holland's honesty? Has he inspired you to be more open about your own challenges?

CELEBRITY · NOW

5

Move over DJs, choreographers are the new stars of social media, with viral dance routines becoming a huge trend!

Videos of fans recreating moves to hits from artists like Zara Larsson and PinkPantheress are taking over feeds. It's all about those catchy steps!

ON AIR – Have you tried any of the viral dance routines yourself? Which one is your favourite?

SOCIAL MEDIA · NOW

On the schedule

1 **George Russell held his nerve to clinch a brilliant victory for Mercedes at the Austrian Grand Prix, fending off Max Verstappen.**

It was a tense battle right to the chequered flag, with Russell showing incredible composure. This win will be a huge boost for Mercedes in the championship.

ON AIR – What a race! Do you think this win puts Russell in contention for the F1 title this year?

F1 · UK

2 **England cricket captain Ben Stokes has announced his retirement from Test cricket, effective after the current series against New Zealand.**

Stokes shared the news with his teammates, marking the end of an era for one of England's most influential players. He will continue to play white-ball cricket.

ON AIR – Ben Stokes has given us so many incredible Test moments. What's your favourite memory of him in an England Test shirt?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Declan Rice is expected to start for England in their World Cup last-32 tie against DR Congo on Wednesday.**

This is great news for England fans, as Rice's presence in midfield is crucial for the team's balance. It's a big match as the knockout stages begin.

ON AIR – How far do you think England can go in this World Cup? What's your prediction for the DR Congo game?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Steve Clarke has stepped down as Scotland head coach following the team's exit from the World Cup group stage.**

Clarke leaves a strong legacy, having guided Scotland out of the international wilderness, but ultimately couldn't get them past the group stage. The search for a successor begins.

ON AIR – Who would you like to see take over as the next Scotland manager? A big-name overseas coach, or a Scottish icon?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Great Britain's rowers absolutely dominated at the World Cup in Lucerne, securing an impressive six gold medals!**

It was a fantastic performance from the GB team, showcasing their strength and talent on the international stage. This bodes well for future competitions.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of rowing? Which other less-mainstream sports do you enjoy watching?

ROWING · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A poll finds the nation can't agree on the correct way to make a cup of tea.**
Milk first or last remains a genuine source of household tension. The one thing we agree on: someone else should make it.
- 2 One in three of us has had a 'sleep divorce' — sleeping in a separate bed from our partner.**
Reasons: snoring (45%), different schedules (30%), restless legs, and one bizarre 12% who say their partner 'talks to the cat in their sleep'.
- 3 A poll finds most people have a song that instantly makes them feel like dancing, even in the kitchen.**
Kitchen discos are a quiet national pastime. The wooden spoon remains the microphone of choice.
- 4 Jigsaw puzzles are still selling in huge numbers, years after their lockdown boom.**
1,000-piece designs are the sweet spot. The most dreaded puzzle remains anything that's mostly sky.
- 5 A study says the smell of fresh bread is one of the few things almost everyone finds comforting.**
Supermarkets have long known it — the in-store bakery is no accident. Few of us escape without an unplanned loaf.
- 6 A poll says most people can't remember the last time they wrote a letter by hand.**
Yet greetings-card sales remain strong — we'll happily sign our name, just not write a full page.
- 7 The number of people learning to play an instrument as an adult is rising fast.**
Piano and guitar lead the way, with online lessons making it easier. The hardest part, learners say, is finding somewhere to practise without an audience.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

- Q** Just over half of us admit to doing **THIS** with the TV remote.
- ANSWER:** HIDING IT SO SOMEONE ELSE CAN'T CHANGE THE CHANNEL.
- Q** Asked the smell that instantly takes us back to childhood, the winner was **THIS**.
- ANSWER:** CUT GRASS ON A SUMMER AFTERNOON.

TALK TOPIC

- **A new survey says the average person has three 'comfort meals' they return to again and again.**
Talk-back: what are yours — and is there one you'd genuinely be happy to eat every single day?
- **Apparently most of us still have a landline number memorised from childhood.**
Whose number can you still recite by heart — and could you remember your own mobile if you tried?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

- FACT** **History.** The Great Fire of London in 1666 destroyed thousands of houses but, remarkably, the official death toll recorded only a handful of people.
- FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** A museum has discovered that a Tudor monarch kept a 'royal sneezer' — a courtier whose sole duty was to sneeze first so the king never had to be the one who started it.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Wall of China isn't actually visible from space without aid, despite the myth.
- There are more possible games of chess than atoms in the observable universe.
- A flock of crows is called a 'murder'.
- The unicorn is mentioned in the Bible nine times.
- Coca-Cola would be green if colouring wasn't added to it.
- A day on Venus is longer than a year on Venus.
- Polar bears have black skin under their white fur.
- Hot water freezes faster than cold water under certain conditions — it's called the Mpemba effect.

On this day

Day 180 of the year, 185 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Cassius of Narni; Christian feast day: Hemma of Gurk; Christian feast day: Mary, mother of John Mark; Christian feast day: Feast of Saints Peter and Paul (Western Christianity), and its related observances: Haro Wine Festival (Haro, La Rioja). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1990 — Kim Little, Scottish footballer
- 1942 — Charlotte Bingham, English author and screenwriter (died 2025)
- 1978 — Luke Kirby, Canadian actor
- 1980 — Katherine Jenkins, Welsh soprano and actress
- 1948 — Fred Grandy, American actor and politician
- 1934 — Corey Allen, American actor, director, and producer (died 2010)
- 1982 — Colin Jost, American comedian
- 1944 — Gary Busey, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1945 — The Soviet Union annexes the Czechoslovak province of Carpathian Ruthenia.
- 1915 — The North Saskatchewan River flood of 1915 is the worst flood in Edmonton history.
- 1971 — Prior to re-entry (following a record-setting stay aboard the Soviet Union's Salyut 1 space station), the crew capsule of the Soyuz 11 spacecraft depressurizes, killing the three cosmonauts on board. Georgy Dobrovolsky, Vladislav Volkov and Viktor Patsayev are the first humans...

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1974 — Vice President Isabel Perón assumes powers and duties as Acting President of Argentina, while her husband President Juan Perón is terminally ill.
- 1972 — A Convair CV-580 and De Havilland Canada DHC-6 Twin Otter collide above Lake Winnebago near Appleton, Wisconsin, killing 13.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1952 — The first Miss Universe pageant is held. Armi Kuusela from Finland wins the title of Miss Universe 1952.
-

1927 — The Bird of Paradise, a U.S. Army Air Corps Fokker tri-motor, completes the first transpacific flight, from the mainland United States to Hawaii.

- 2007 — Apple Inc. releases its first mobile phone, the iPhone.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 181 of the year, 184 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Erentrude; Christian feast day: St. Paul the Apostle (solo feast day); Christian feast day: St. Mary of Jerusalem, mother of Apostle Mark the Evangelist first Bishop of Alexandria and Byblos; Christian feast day: St. Martial. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1964 — Mark Waters, American director and producer
- 1937 — Larry Henley, American singer-songwriter (died 2014)
- 1954 — Stephen Barlow, English organist, composer, and conductor
- 1984 — Fantasia Barrino, American singer-songwriter and actress
- 1936 — Nancy Dussault, American actress and singer
- 1952 — David Garrison, American actor and singer
- 1933 — M. J. K. Smith, English cricketer and rugby player
- 1943 — Florence Ballard, American pop/soul singer (died 1976)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1994 — An Airbus A330-300 crashes during a test flight at Toulouse–Blagnac Airport, killing all seven people on board.
- 1985 — Thirty-nine American hostages from the hijacked TWA Flight 847 are freed in Beirut after being held for 17 days.
- 1986 — The U.S. Supreme Court rules in *Bowers v. Hardwick* that states can outlaw homosexual acts between consenting adults.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2023 — A Tajik citizen with ISIS connections, wanted in Tajikistan for murder and kidnapping, kills two people at Chişinău International Airport in Moldova, after being denied entry to the country.
- 2009 — Yemenia Flight 626, an Airbus A310-300, crashes into the Indian Ocean near Comoros, killing 152 of the 153 people on board. A 14-year-old girl named Bahia Bakari survives the crash.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)